CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 11: **Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. In 'Found light / Brighter than many ever see', which reading best fits the poet's purpose? 1

(a) Keller preferred darkness
(b) light is brightest at noon
(c) inner insight can outshine physical sight
(d) few people like light

2. The enjambment 'And now the world receives / From her dower' is used to: 1

(a) end the poem **(b)** start a new stanza
(c) carry the sentence smoothly across lines **(d)** add a rhyme

3. 'Wonder and admiration' in the summary shows the poet's response is: 1

(a) emotional and respectful **(b)** detached
(c) critical **(d)** puzzled

4. The expression 'She, / In the dark' contains an irony, because: 1

(a) the poet is blind
(b) she is afraid of the dark
(c) light is found in dark rooms
(d) the one in the dark finds more light than those who see

5. The syntax of 'Found light / Brighter than many ever see' omits a subject because: 1

(a) it is a mistake
(b) 'She' from the previous line carries over
(c) the poet forgot
(d) it is a question

6. Which pair of terms best matches the poem's two dominant images? 1

(a) dark and light **(b)** fire and ice **(c)** sea and sky **(d)** city and farm

7. Which best describes the paradox of the poem? 1

(a) a poor person is rich in coins
(b) a loud person is silent
(c) a blind person brings light to a seeing world
(d) a lazy person succeeds

8. The poem's brevity best matches the idea that: 1

(a) strength needs no ornament **(b)** brevity is weakness
(c) a long poem is better **(d)** poets avoid detail

9. 'Loveliness' found 'within herself' counters the belief that: 1

(a) poets are wise **(b)** beauty is only outward
(c) beauty fades daily **(d)** beauty is rare

10. The poet's repeated use of 'found' suggests discovery as: 1

(a) a loss **(b)** an accident
(c) an active, personal achievement **(d)** a gift from strangers

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Explain the paradox in 'She, / In the dark, / Found light'. 2

12. How does the poem reflect the theme of SDG 'Reduced Inequalities'? 2

13. How does a compact form make the message more forceful? 2

14. How does the poem use symbolism rather than description to praise Keller? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically examine the idea of 'light' in the poem: is it a gift or an achievement? 3

16. Discuss the contrast between 'many' and 'she' and what it implies about perception. 3

17. Identify the part of speech of each: found, loveliness, brighter. 3

OR

Discuss how the poem links inner vision with social responsibility. 3

18. Analyse the importance of rhythm and line-length in the poem. 3

OR

Explain with an example how a poet can use a single word line for emphasis. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write a critical appreciation of 'Helen Keller' covering theme, imagery, form, tone and message. 5

OR

Discuss the poem as a response to inequality and prejudice. 5

20. Compare 'light' in stanza one and 'loveliness' in stanza two; how do they build towards the 'dower'? 5

OR

Write an article for the school magazine on 'The Strength Within', using Keller's life and this poem. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks